

5. PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE

5.1 Setting Up the Service / Service Offering

Work begins by creating or locating the service or service offering in ServiceNow that the incident will belong to. This is used at the point of incident creation so the ticket is tied to the correct business service, and its configuration is checked before any incidents are logged against it.

5.2 Logging the Incident Record

A new incident is opened from the Incident module with the following entered:

- Caller
- Service / Service Offering
- Short Description
- Detailed Description
- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Assignment information

Once submitted, ServiceNow assigns a unique incident number and the ticket enters its initial active state.

5.3 Classifying the Incident

The new incident is classified against the reported problem: the right category and subcategory are chosen, impact reflects how much the issue affects the business, and urgency reflects how quickly it needs fixing. Priority is then derived from impact and urgency together, so that incidents that are both high-impact and high-urgency get attention faster.

5.4 Making Use of the Knowledge Base

Before diving into detailed troubleshooting, the Service Desk Agent checks the ServiceNow Knowledge Base for any article that already documents a fix for the reported problem. If a matching article exists, its steps are followed during the investigation — cutting down repeat troubleshooting and speeding up resolution.

5.5 Assignment and Escalation

Once classified, the incident is routed to the appropriate support group, and the assigned agent begins first-line troubleshooting. If the Service Desk Agent can't close it out, the ticket escalates to Level 2 support, carrying its full activity history forward so the next team can see what's already been tried.

5.6 Raising an Emergency Change

If, during investigation, it becomes clear that fixing the incident needs an urgent change to a system or piece of infrastructure, an **Emergency Change Request** is created, capturing:

- Reason for the change
- Description of what's being changed
- Affected service/system
- Implementation plan
- Risk assessment
- Approvals required

This request is then linked back to the original incident so there's a clear trail between the reported problem and the technical fix applied.

5.7 Creating a Child Incident

Where the same root cause affects more than one user or service, a child incident is created. The original incident becomes the parent, and the child is linked to it so related problems can be tracked as a group — improving visibility and cutting down duplicate investigation work.

5.8 Resolving the Incident

Once the root cause has been fixed, the agent updates the incident with:

- Resolution code
- Resolution notes
- Details of the actions taken
- Any relevant communication with the user

The ticket then moves to the **Resolved** state, with resolution notes written clearly enough to explain both what caused the problem and how it was fixed.

5.9 Writing a Knowledge Article

If the fix found here could help with future incidents, a new knowledge article is created covering:

Problem: what the issue was. **Symptoms:** what the user actually experienced. **Cause:** what was found to be the root cause. **Resolution:** the steps used to fix it. **Additional Information:** any precautions or extra context worth noting.

This turns the experience of resolving one incident into knowledge the whole organization can reuse.

5.10 Checking the SLA

The SLA tied to the incident is reviewed to confirm whether response and resolution targets were met, giving visibility into how well the support process is performing.

5.11 Validating Related Records

Before the lifecycle is considered complete, all related records are checked, including:

- Parent incident
- Child incident
- Emergency change request
- Knowledge article
- SLA records
- Assignment information

This confirms the full incident lifecycle has been properly captured and documented.